

Julian R. Ornelas

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SUMMARY

Enthusiastic, motivated, and results-driven data professional with a strong background in data analysis, machine learning, data management, and pipeline development. Proven track record of delivering end-to-end projects to solve business challenges and improve processes. Exceptional communication and presentation skills enabling clear storytelling for diverse audiences. Recognized for adaptability, strong stakeholder engagement, and effective project management, reinforced by a collaborative, team-oriented mindset.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming & Querying: Python, R, SQL, SAS

Data Analysis & Visualization: Power BI, Tableau, Excel, Jupyter Notebook

Machine Learning & Statistics: Regression, Classification, Hypothesis Testing, Feature Engineering, Model Evaluation

Big Data & Cloud: AWS, Databricks, PySpark

Databases & Tools: MySQL, Git/GitHub

Other: Data Quality, ETL Pipelines, Dashboard Creation, KPI Tracking, Stakeholder Reporting, Data Storytelling

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Otsuka Pharmaceutical Companies, Inc. — Data Scientist Intern (Healthcare Analytics)

Remote | May 2025 - Aug 2025

- Analyzed large-scale event-level wearable sensor data (Fitbit) and patient-reported outcomes using Python-based workflows to identify statistically significant behavioral patterns linked to depression severity.
- Conducted literature reviews to narrow focus from 40+ digital features down to 5 features.
- Applied statistical modeling techniques including regression analysis, feature engineering, and hypothesis testing to extract insights from longitudinal data.
- Generated data visualizations to communicate findings to company leaders, enabling data-driven research decisions.

American AgCredit — Enterprise Tools Intern (Data Analyst - Business Intelligence)

Remote | Jun 2024 - Aug 2024

- Designed and deployed Power BI dashboards tracking user engagement KPIs and platform usage metrics to support executive-level decision-making.
- Automated data pipelines and reporting workflows, reducing manual reporting time by over 90% and enabling near real-time analytics.
- Translated business requirements into actionable dashboards by partnering with product, IT, and business stakeholders.
- Developed documentation for ad-hoc acquisition of new data and refreshing of dashboards.

SpaceLab — Data Scientist (Python, AWS, ETL Pipelines)

Remote | Jan 2023 - Aug 2023

- Built scalable Python-based ETL pipelines on AWS to ingest, preprocess, and analyze large-scale event-level satellite data for use in exoplanet detection.
- Optimized data-processing performance, reducing pipeline runtime by over 60% through profiling, debugging, and parallelization improvements.
- Collaborated cross-functionally with engineering and data science teams to improve pipeline reliability and production readiness.

NASA Ames Research Center — Machine Learning Intern (Data Scientist - Predictive Modeling)

Remote | Jun 2021 - Aug 2021

- Developed and evaluated tree-based machine learning models to predict experimental outcomes, improving model performance by approximately 15%.
- Performed feature engineering, model validation, and statistical performance analysis to support predictive accuracy.
- Supported experimental data ingestion by building APIs to migrate large volumes of legacy spreadsheet data into structured databases.

DraftKings — College Basketball Data Scout (Data Quality, Data Entry)

Sep 2025 - Present

- Collected and validated real-time event-level basketball game data used in downstream analytics and product features.
- Maintained strict data quality standards while operating in a fast-paced, high-volume data environment.

EDUCATION

San Diego State University — San Diego, CA

Master of Science in Big Data Analytics | May 2025

GPA: 3.97/4.0

Relevant Coursework: Databases, Machine Learning, Geographic Information Systems, Big Data Programming, Statistical Analysis

Santa Clara University — Santa Clara, CA

Master of Arts in Teaching (Single-Subject Teaching Credential)

Bachelor of Science in Mathematics, Minor: Urban Education

PROJECTS

Psyche Track: Mental Health Screening Platform | May 2025

- Designed an AI-driven screening platform prototype to calculate one's risk of experiencing severe depression by analyzing user behavior signals including speech patterns, facial expressions, and sentiment features.
- Developed scalable architecture concepts for real-world healthcare deployment.

San Diego County Mental Health Resource Analysis | May 2025

- Conducted geospatial and statistical analysis of mental health case distribution using census tract data.
- Performed buffer zone analysis to identify underserved populations and resource access gaps.

NFL Combine Draft Impact Analysis | Dec 2024

- Built linear and logistic regression models to evaluate relationships between performance metrics and draft outcomes.
- Identified statistically-significant predictors influencing draft position.

CERTIFICATIONS & AWARDS

Certifications:

- Excel Skills for Business Specialization — Coursera
- Data Analytics Certificate — UC Santa Cruz, Silicon Valley Extension

Awards & Honors:

- Academic Excellence Certificate (4.0 GPA) — SDSU
- Pi Mu Epsilon Mathematics Honor Society — SCU
- Kappa Delta Pi Education Honor Society — SCU